

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



BAD MEASURE:
Candidates fudged medical
and birth certificates

OFF WITH THEIR KHAKIS

Mayawati sacks over 6,500 policemen after an inquiry points to corruption and nepotism by the Mulayam Singh government which chose candidates on the basis of caste, not ability

CLEANING UP:
Mayawati



YASBANT NEGI

■ By Subhash Mishra

Among the many prerequisites for joining the police force are that the candidate should be physically fit, of sound mind, and be able to read and write, with height and weight within the prescribed parameters. And of course, he should not be a criminal.

In Uttar Pradesh, you don't need any of these to don the khaki uniform. An investigation ordered by Chief Minister Mayawati into the complaints of mass irregularities in police recruitments during the last three-and-a-half years of the Mulayam Singh Yadav regime has shown that lawlessness was prevalent even among the guardians of the law. Several senior IPS officers of the ranks of DIG and SSP worked against the interests of the state by recruiting not only unqualified people, but also those with a criminal

background, to create a force that was loyal not to the state but to the political party in power. The motive, it has now been established, was to create a private army of over 22,000 constables by favouring candidates from the Yadav caste, to which the then chief minister belonged. Last week, Mayawati promised to take stringent action against the guilty after suspending 12 IPS officers, including one IG, six DIGs and two SPS who were part of the selection board, in addition to 6,500 constables. Two of the IPS officers are on deputation with the Central Government and letters for their suspension have been dispatched to the Centre.

Two years ago, when the Mulayam government had kickstarted the recruitment process, there were murmurs of favouritism and money changing hands. Some PILs were also filed and petitions submitted to the